

Key Definitions

- See [Global Travel Expense Procedures](#)

Related Policies and Processes

- [Global Travel Expense Procedures](#)
- [Local Country T&E Policy Addendum](#)
- [Addendum Tables](#)
- [Corporate Card Policy](#)
- [Corporate Card Request App](#)
- Relocation Policies:
 - [International Relocation Policy](#)
 - [Domestic Relocation Policy](#)
 - [New Hire Relocation Policy](#)
- [Cognizant's Ethics & Compliance Helpline](#)
- [Code of Ethics](#)
- [Financial Stewardship Policy](#)
- [Anti-Corruption Policy](#)
- [Procedure for Gifts & Entertainment](#)

Scope

This Policy sets forth the Cognizant mandates with respect to the principles, responsibilities, and practices related to the incurrence, approval, and reimbursement of Business Travel-related expenses, excluding relocation. This Policy applies to all directors, officers, and Associates of Cognizant entities, subsidiaries and joint ventures over which Cognizant has operational control (collectively "Associates"). Where there are local directives which differ from the global policy, Associates must follow the practices in their [Local Country T&E Policy Addendum](#), which they should read in conjunction with this Global policy.

This policy does not relate to relocation for short- or long-term assignments. See the Company's [international](#), [domestic](#) and [new hire](#) relocation policies on the [Global Mobility site](#) for additional guidance.

In addition to complying with the standards set out in this Policy, Associates are expected to behave consistently with Cognizant's [Code of Ethics](#), the spirit of this Policy, and local laws and regulations, including situations where a specific circumstance is not explicitly defined within this Policy.

Guiding Principles

Cognizant is committed to maintaining a safe and rigorous process for Associates to manage travel and expenses in line with business objectives. Non-essential travel is discouraged. Before incurring travel expenses, Associates should consider whether the business outcome of the trip could be achieved through web, teleconference, or video conference facilities. Appropriate usage of company credit cards and proper travel and expense management is critical to ensuring good financial stewardship across the organization. The American Express Corporate Card **MUST** be used for ALL **business travel** and **other reimbursable business expenses** (as per the addendum to the Global T&E Policy) where it is accepted. Certain capitalized terms are defined in the [Global Travel Expense Procedures](#) document.

Associates should understand and comply with the following guiding principles:

I. Booking Travel. To better manage costs, Cognizant has partnered with preferred suppliers and uses concur, an online booking tool, or our [Corporate Travel Agency](#) to book Business Travel (e.g., air, lodging, car rental). Associates must book through preferred suppliers via company booking channels only and consider less expensive and

environmentally friendly travel options, where available. Associates are responsible for keeping their travel profile updated. Refer to the [Global Travel Expense Procedures](#) for more information.

All travel bookings [flights, accommodations, self-driven car rentals, long-distance trains (min. travel time 3 hours for domestic trips)] through Concur Travel or CWT Agency need a pre-travel approval code, even for same-day travel. **The only exception is same-day domestic travel by taxi or bus without accommodation or air travel or self-driven car rental.** Basically, any travel booking you need to make either through Concur Travel or CWT, or any international travel would need an approved pre-travel code, regardless of travel duration / travel mode. Refer to [Pre Travel Approval - FAQ](#) for more information.

- a. **Rewards Programs.** Associates may retain the benefits from rewards programs for personal use. However, Associates may not select travel providers based on points earned from frequent use programs. Membership fees associated with rewards programs are not reimbursable.
- b. **Personal travel.** Personal/vacation travel may be combined with Business Travel if no additional costs are incurred by Cognizant and you have approval from your HCM manager.

II. **Airfare and Train.** Associates are expected to exercise good judgment in determining what mode of transportation is most appropriate. Associates must book airfare using concur or the [Corporate Travel Agency](#). They must book non-refundable fares and accept the lowest logical airfare (LLF), which may only be exceeded when booking with one of our preferred airlines and when costs do not exceed the LLF by more than \$100 USD or local equivalent for a domestic flight or \$400 USD or local equivalent for an international flight. Country exceptions can be found in the [Local Country T&E Policy Addendum](#)

a. **Airfare Booking:**

- **US & Canada :** All Airfare expenses must be booked using the **individual associate's Amex corporate credit card** if the associate has one.
 - Associates who do not have a corporate credit card must apply for one through the [Corporate Card App](#), subject to eligibility.
 - All SM+ associates and frequent travelers at manager level and below are required to obtain a card
 - For business-critical or urgent travel, if the associate does not have an individual corporate credit card, airfare must be booked using the **central Amex BTA corporate credit card**
- **Other than US & Canada :** All Airfare expenses must be booked using the **central Amex BTA corporate credit card**

- b. Approvals.** All travel must be pre-approved before booking by raising request via Pre-Travel Approval Form and securing approval code and later book through company booking channels only. Refer to [Pre Travel Approval - FAQ](#) for more information.
- c. Advance Booking.** To obtain the best rate, flights should be booked as far in advance as possible, but no later than 14 days for 3+ hour trips within Europe and for all international flights originating in the rest of the world, and 7 days for domestic flights.
- d. Airfare Class (Effective April 20, 2023)** [Click here](#)

	Flight Duration (hours)	
	<6	Above 6 hours
EC Members*	←-----Business-----→	
VP, SVP and EVPs (who are not EC Members) [^]	Economy [^]	Lowest Logical Business Class & Fare Cap of USD 7000 for Round Trip
All others	Economy	

* Refer to the list of EC Members in [Addendum Tables](#).

[^] For VP, SVP and EVPs (who are not EC Members): All domestic flights irrespective of flying hours need to be booked in economy class only, with the exception of a named group listed in the [Addendum Tables](#), for whom business class will be allowed with the restrictions as mentioned for 6+ hours trips.

e. Train Travel Class.

- (i) **EC Members:** Business class / 1st class
(ii) **All Others:** Economy or 2nd class.

In case there are different train fares available for economy/standard/2nd class, the cheapest fare category must be chosen.

f. Cancelled Tickets. Cancelled, non-refundable tickets must be applied to future Business Travel and remain the property of Cognizant.

g. Reimbursable Air and Train Costs. Refer [Addendum Tables](#) for a list of reimbursable and non-reimbursable airfare and train costs.

III. Hotels and Lodging. Hotels and extended stay hotels must be booked using concur or the [Corporate Travel Agency](#). City Hotel Rate Caps (excluding tax) have been applied through these channels. Guest houses, Airbnb through “Cognizant’s Airbnb for Work program”, corporate apartments or conference hotels are also acceptable, however,

they may not exceed City Hotel Rate Caps. Non-refundable hotel rates or instant-purchase rates are not permitted.

a. Hotel Booking:

- **Global :** All Hotel expenses must be booked using the **individual associate's Amex corporate credit card** if the associate has one.
 - Associates who do not have a corporate credit card must apply for one through the [Corporate Card App](#), subject to eligibility.
 - a. All SM+ associates and frequent travelers at manager level and below are required to obtain a card
- If the Amex Corporate Card is **not accepted** by the merchant or If the associate **does not have a corporate credit card**, an alternative payment method (such as personal credit card) may be used

- b. Signed Leases.** Corporate apartment leases may be appropriate for “Fly-in / Fly-out” consultants, who travel to a site Monday through Thursday, returning home on Friday. Lease should cover the anticipated time period for project completion. All apartment leases must be signed by Global Travel. A signed copy of the lease must be submitted through Concur for monthly lease payments.

With a legitimate business reason, lease breakage costs that are the lower of \$3,500 USD or two months' rent may be charged. If not approved, the Associate is responsible to personally pay for cancellation costs.

- c. Reimbursable Accommodation Costs.** See the [Addendum Tables](#) for a list of reimbursable and non-reimbursable accommodation costs.

IV. Ground Transportation. Associates should select ground transportation options that provide the best overall value, taking into consideration cost, safety, availability, dependability, and scheduling needs.

- a. Taxi, Rideshare Services and Public Transport.** Taxi, rideshare, and public transportation are reimbursable, with the submission of proper receipts. Lyft in the U.S. and Uber in the rest of the world are acceptable rideshare options. Associates should not ride with individuals they do not know. To set up a business rideshare account, see the [Local Country T&E Policy Addendum](#)
- b. Personal Vehicle.** Associates will be reimbursed on a per mile or kilometer basis for use of their personal vehicle when it is properly insured and more efficient than rideshare or rental car options. Only mileage in excess of normal commuting mileage is reimbursable. Mileage relating to Associates' normal commute is not

reimbursable. Refer to the [Local Country T&E Policy Addendum](#) for reimbursement rates, coverage, and requirements. The Company accepts no liability for accidents or traffic violations.

c. Parking and Tolls: Reasonable charges are reimbursable.

d. Reimbursable Costs. Refer [Addendum Tables](#) for a list of reimbursable and non-reimbursable costs.

V. Rental Cars. Midsize rental cars may be hired only when they offer better value than rideshares or public transportation, or when taking safety and travel time into consideration.

- **Insurance and Fees.** When booking rental cars through concur or the [Corporate Travel Agency](#), Associates must decline insurance when renting within the U.S., as insurance coverage is included in base rental rates. Renters booking cars outside the U.S. should consult the [Local Country T&E Policy Addendum](#) for guidance. You should decline all insurance coverage where the guidance indicates that insurance is included in the rates. Only employees should operate rental vehicles. Associates should return the car with a full tank of gas, avoiding refueling charges or pre-paid options, and add-on services, such as GPS or satellite radio are not reimbursable.

VI. Employee Meals. Associates will be reimbursed for reasonable meal costs incurred during out of town Business Travel which requires an overnight stay. Refer to the Meal Guidelines in the [Addendum Tables](#) and the [Local Country T&E Policy Addendum](#) for more information, specifically which host countries reimburse actual meal costs and which provide per diem allowances.

VII. Meals and Entertainment:

a. Team Meals:

- Team Meals and Entertainment expenses will be reimbursed at actual cost upon submission of itemized receipts. Where meal costs are incurred by a group of associates and settled on one account, the most senior associate is responsible for paying for the event and submitting an expense report, including the names of all attendees.

EC Members: The total spend threshold is USD 2000, refer to the list of EC Members in [Addendum Tables](#)

All Others: If the total spend exceeds USD 1000 (applicable for all countries/regions) then it is mandatory to attach an exception approval e-mail

from the first D+ person either in the PM's or your upward reporting hierarchy in HCM, who is not part of the attendee list.

- Exceptional cases where a spouse / partner / family member's meal needs to be expensed, an approval from VP+ / HCM upward Hierarchy is required to be attached with the expense report.

b. Client Meals & Entertainment: T&E submission for government projects require that the number of attendees listed agrees with the number reflected on the restaurant receipt. Associates must review [Cognizant's Procedure for Gifts and Entertainment](#) and obtain any necessary approvals prior to incurring any expense on behalf of a client.

VIII. Limitations on Executives Traveling Together: The continuity of our business necessitates that we limit the number of critical associates, Directors and Senior Executives, who travel together on the same mode of transportation. Hence, the following specific requirements and guidance should be observed. For more information, please refer [Cognizant Executive Travel Risk Mitigation Policy](#)

- **Air Travel**

- The CEO and CFO should not travel on the same flight.
- The CFO should not travel on the same flight as the Chief Accounting Officer or the Controller.
- The CEO should travel with no more than 3 other Senior Executives on the same flight.
- The CFO should travel with no more than 3 other Senior Executives on the same flight.
- No more than 4 Senior Executives should travel on the same flight.
- No more than 4 members of the Cognizant board of directors should be arranged to travel on the same flight.

- **Ground Transportation**

Risk analysis should be considered in each case of ground transportation use. Urban travel at lower speeds is recognized as safer than travelling on open roads at high speeds. For urban travel, groups of Senior Executives and Cognizant directors may, based on distance, vehicle being used, location and general safety of the roads being traveled on, etc., be reasonably arranged to travel together. However, when travel involves meaningful amounts of freeway/highway travel at higher speed (over 50 mph / 80 kph), the same guidelines as set out above under "Air Travel" should be observed with respect to travel in the same vehicle.

IX. Meetings and Events. Assuming nightly rates do not exceed the City Hotel Rate Cap, associates traveling with clients or attending a sponsored event may stay at client or sponsor-arranged hotels.

- X. Governance.** The Global Travel Team is responsible for the governance of all employee Business Travel and travel related to meetings and relocations. Other business units or departments are not authorized to negotiate separate agreements with travel suppliers, including, but not limited to airlines, hotels, and car rental companies.
- XI. Health and Safety.** Cognizant provides medical assistance for Associates while they are on Business Travel. Visit the [Travel Insurance](#) or contact your Talent manager for more details. Associates must comply with travel restrictions and the Company's duty of care. Travel to restricted destinations and/or destinations that are subject to a travel advisory require approval from Global Security. The list of restricted destinations and employee travel advisories are posted on [Cognizant's Corporate Security](#) site.
- XII. Expenses.** Cognizant will reimburse Associates for necessary, reasonable and approved Business Travel and expenses. For a list of reimbursable and non-reimbursable expenses along with Work From Home allowances for selected countries, see the [Addendum Tables](#). Out-of-policy expenditures will not be reimbursed without proper exception approval from the Policy Exception Approver for Travel and Expense. Written approval must be attached to the submitted expense report.

"Google Street View" Project Expenses : Small peripherals supplies, tools, screws, any equipment purchased to maintain the program by the Google Street View technicians, will be reimbursed based on the Pre-agreement from the Policy owner, the customer and the project team, Google Street View, over the life of client contract of 3 years. Refer "Reimbursable Expenses " in [Addendum Tables](#)

- a. Travel & Expense Reports.** T&E reports should be submitted within 14 days of expenditure to avoid late fees. Receipts or invoices, unless otherwise noted in the [Addendum Tables](#), must be included with T&E report submissions. Charge slips and credit card statements are not adequate receipt support.

If airfare expenses are not booked using the individual corporate credit card or the central Amex BTA card, the associate must attach the **boarding pass** when submitting the expense claim in exception cases.

All expenses related to a single charge must be included in one T&E report. Associates making multiple claims for a single charge, with the intention of bypassing the authorization limits are acting in violation of this Policy and may be subject to disciplinary action.

Any exceptions to the T&E policy for air travel LLF cap or fare cap, hotel cap or advance booking for air travel deadlines may not be reimbursed in Concur Expense claims in case no exception approval obtained.

- b. Corporate Card and Payment.** The [Corporate Travel Card Process and Policy](#) describes acceptable use of the corporate card, including eligibility, personal use, and approved purchases.

All **SM+ associates** must hold an American Express Corporate Card in the countries where it is offered

Associates with grades of **manager and below** may obtain a card if they are frequent travelers (averaging one travel per quarter over 12 months period) with approval from their HCM Manager (first D+ person in the associate's upward reporting hierarchy in HCM)

Associates are strictly prohibited from using their Amex Corporate Card for personal expenses or for booking travel on behalf of others.

- Use of the Corporate Card by any associate for personal expenses is grounds for disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Any items purchased on behalf of the Company may not be used for private purposes and must be returned upon the end of an Associate's employment with Cognizant.

- c. Contractors.** No costs related to subcontractors, whether it be for wages or any travel and entertainment, are reimbursable through T&E. Through Q3 2021, such payments must be made through Cognizant's supplier invoicing process. Thereafter, Cognizant will pay T&E to subcontractors using the same system through which they record their time entry.

XIII. Disciplinary Consequences

Subject to local laws and regulations, a violation of this policy or abuse of travel, meeting, or expense privileges could result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination. If you are aware of a violation of this policy, you have an obligation to report it to the Company. As stated in Cognizant's [Whistleblower and Non-Retaliation Policy](#), Cognizant does not tolerate retaliation against any individual who submits a good faith report of a violation or possible violation of law, the Code of Ethics, or other Cognizant policies.

To report a possible violation of this policy, visit Cognizant's Ethics & Compliance Helpline (a secure and confidential reporting system) at: www.cognizant.com/compliance-helpline.

XIV. Version History

Revision Date	Description of Change
April 1, 2021	Initial draft
April 12, 2021	Added 'Work From Home' verbiage
August 27, 2021	Updated meals and entertainment
Sept. 29, 2021	Updated Team meals and added meal threshold for EC member & above.
Dec 2, 2021	Removed region wise threshold table under Team Meals and updated team meal threshold for Non EC members and EC members.
Dec 22, 2021	Spouse / Partner / Family member's meal expense added under Team Meals
Jan 13, 2022	Revised section VIII and added "Executive Travel Risk Mitigation Policy" link.
Feb 7, 2022	Added expense reimbursement for 'Google Street View' project. Refer Expenses.
May 19, 2022	Verbiage on EC communication added under Team Meals
June 17, 2022	Airfare Class table updated under section II (c)
June 29, 2022	Revision in Train Travel class under section II (d)
July 28, 2022	Removed verbiage on EC communication regarding team meals restriction from section VII (a)
April 18, 2023	Updated revised business class policy and threshold for domestic and International travel.
June 7, 2023	Updated new link of all policy documents after Be.Cognizant migration
June 7, 2023	Revision to Train Class verbiage
June 17, 2023	Revision in verbiage under Team Meals
Sept 21, 2023	Added 'Boarding Pass' requirement under section XII (a)
Jan 19, 2024	Revised Policy owner details updated
July 24, 2024	Updated PTA FAQ link
Oct 24, 2024	Revision in Pre Travel Approval process, refer "Booking Travel" under section (I)
May 28, 2025	Replaced EC member /EVP with 'Chiefs / Presidents (in grade levels 15 or below)' in policy.

Feb 09, 2026	Replaced Chiefs / Presidents with 'Chief Officers and Presidents' and updated Corp. Card eligibility and approval for Manager and below associates.
Feb 26, 2026	Revision in PTA code requirement under section (I) 'Booking Travel'
May 26, 2026	Replaced 'Chief Officers / Presidents' with EC members and Addendum Tables link provided to refer EC member list.
June 9, 2026	Revision in airfare class for a named group under section II(d)

Policy Control Information :

Policy Name: Global Travel and Expense Policy

Department: Finance

Revision Date: June 9, 2026

Effective Date: June 9, 2026

Policy Owner: Pradip De, Finance

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